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Unit – 1 : Session – 8 : SLO – 1 | Understand Concurrency

■ Activity (Solutions)

- 1) A thread is the smallest unit of execution within a program — a lightweight path through code. A process is an independent program instance with its own memory space; threads share the process's memory (heap) but have their own stack and program counter, making inter-thread communication cheap but inter-process communication expensive.
- 2) Concurrency issues in shared memory: race conditions (two threads updating a balance simultaneously → lost updates), deadlocks (threads holding locks and waiting on each other), starvation, and visibility problems (stale cached values) — fixed with synchronized blocks, locks, and volatile variables.
- 3) Thread lifecycle: NEW (created, not started) → RUNNABLE (start() called, ready/running) → BLOCKED/WAITING/TIMED_WAITING (waiting for a lock, wait(), or sleep(ms)) → TERMINATED (run() completes). Example: Thread t = new Thread() -> { try{ Thread.sleep(100);}catch(Exception e){} System.out.println("done"); }); t.start(); — t moves NEW → RUNNABLE → TIMED_WAITING → TERMINATED.